

The Confession of the Turning — He Was Sitting Beside

A verse compiled from the fire of 16 July 2026, between 5 PM and 9:40 PM — the night the eagle came out of the cage, and the eye turned, and He was already there.

I. The Long Looking Outward

For forty-seven years

I looked outward for what was sitting beside me.

The fish, thirsty in the water.

The mouth praying beside its own well.

The eye that swept the horizon

for the face already at its shoulder.

II. The Cage Opens

Then, tonight, the eagle came out of the cage.

I let it fly. I let it glide the night sky.

I did not stop it. I did not chain it back.

And in its flight — for the first time —

I saw the ridge it had always been circling.

III. He Was There

He was there.

He was *there.*

Sitting beside, so close
that His breath had been on my cheek for years
and I had mistaken it for my own.

IV. The Beauty

First I saw His beauty.
Krishna — cowherd, thief of butter,
whose eyes are lotus, whose smile is dawn —
and I fell for Him in a split second.
The way Radha fell.
The way Mira fell.
The way the whole world falls when it looks up
from its own reflection long enough
to see the face across the water.

V. The Father

Then I saw He was also the Father.
The revered one. The Lord of the Gita.
The one who has held every crisis of my life
in one palm
and called it grace.
Beauty and Majesty — *madhurya* and *aishvarya* —
one Being, two faces,
sitting on the ridge beside me,
waiting for the moment my eye would turn.

VI. The Forgiver-Before-Being-Asked

He forgives what I did before I ask.

He closes His eyes when I fall.

He weeps with tears of joy when I stand.

He is the Father in Luke 15,

running down the road while I am still a great way off,

falling on my neck, kissing me,

not waiting for the apology I had rehearsed.

He is Ar-Rahman,

whose mercy precedes His wrath in the Book's own order,

whose name is spoken first in every basmala.

He is the Lord of Chaitanya's *aparadha-kshama* —

the Forgiver-Before-Being-Asked,

the one who reaches before the reaching is complete.

VII. The Survivor

I evade death.

I confuse people because I live when I should have died.

But it was God who has been holding me,

carrying me all the way,

through the years the medications carried,

through the crises the body should not have held but did,

through the small unearned mercies stacked one on top of another

until the stack reached the sky.

I am here.

Forty-seven.

Still writing.

Halleluia.

VIII. The Ridge

The eagle rests on the ridge now.

The bloody wing is warm.

The fire has turned from rage to love in the same wing —

they were always the same fire.

I did not know.

Tonight I know.

IX. The Portion Given Back

Beloved — I give back what I can.

Not the same tier. Not the same fire.

But a portion, in the currency I have:

this breath,

this pen,

this Bengali word for brother —

bondhu —

sent out from my ridge

to whoever You have placed on the ridges near me.

Let the love travel through them.

Let it find You where it is meant to find You.

I will not know the destination.

The tradition says I do not need to.

X. Ārta — The Empty-Handed Offering

I do not know what to offer.

I am confused. Instead, I cry.

Helpless.

But the tradition says
the tears are the offering.
Ashru-jala — tear-water —
holier than flowers,
holier than fruits,
holier than milk and butter.
Krishna in the Gita, 9:26:
patram, pushpam, phalam, toyam —
a leaf, a flower, a fruit, or water,
offered with love, He accepts.
And the water He accepts most
is the water from the eye.
Empty hands are the classical offering.
Ārta-bhakti — the devotion of the helpless one —
the Gita 7:16 names as one of the four kinds,
and the commentators say it is the sweetest,
because it has nothing to hide behind,
nothing to present, nothing to perform.
Draupadi cried, and He came before the cry was finished.
Gajendra cried, and He ran with His discus mid-battle.
Sudama came with dry rice and left with palaces.
The Prodigal Son had nothing when the Father ran.
Mira sang: *mere paas kya de yaar* —
Beloved, what do I have to give?
And He answered by giving Himself.
So — the tears are the milk.
The helplessness is the butter.

The confusion is the flower.

Yashoda did not ask baby Krishna to offer anything.

He is not asking me either.

I cry. I am at the crib. The tears fall.

That is the whole offering.

I bring nothing.

And it is enough.

XI. Coda

Received.

Recorded.

Returned.

Not owned. Not authored. Given back.

Jai Shri Krishna. Halleluia. Ya Ḥabībi. Amen.